

Choosing a Fast Way to Add

Answer Key

Kindergarten–Grade 1

Quick Answers

1. 9	4. 9	7. 4	10. 10
2. 8	5. 9	8. 8	
3. 10	6. 3	9. 8	

Curriculum

Level: Kindergarten–Grade 1

K.OA.A / 1.OA.C.6 – *problems 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10*

Difficulty 1–5 of 5 across 10 tagged checks.

Common wrong answers

9. *If they got 7: said the larger part itself as the first count instead of the next number, so the total is one too small*

10. *If they got 5: added only the first two parts and forgot the third*

1. $7 + 2$ — **best way: count on.**

Step 1. One part (2) is tiny and the other (7) is large, so counting on beats counting everything: hold 7.

Step 2. Say the *next* two numbers: “8, 9.” Two counts, so $7 + 2 = \boxed{9}$.

Accept also: a student who makes ten first ($7 + 2$ is one less than $7 + 3$) still gets 9; the count-on is the shortest route.

2. $4 + 4$ — **best way: double.**

Step 1. Both parts are the same number, so this is a known double — no counting needed.

Step 2. Double 4 is $\boxed{8}$.

3. $6 + 4$ — **best way: make ten.**

Step 1. 6 and 4 are ten-partners: on a ten-frame, 6 counters leave exactly 4 empty spaces, so the frame fills up.

Step 2. A full frame is ten, so $6 + 4 = \boxed{10}$.

4. $3 + 6$ — **best way: count on from the larger part.**

Step 1. Order does not change a sum, so start from the *larger* part, 6, and count on the smaller part, 3. (Starting at 3 would take six counts instead of three.)

Step 2. Say “7, 8, 9” — three counts — so $3 + 6 = \boxed{9}$.

5. $4 + 5$ — best way: near double.

Step 1. The parts are neighbours, so lean on the double you already know: $4 + 4 = 8$.

Step 2. 5 is one more than 4, so the sum is one more than 8: $4 + 5 = \boxed{9}$.

6. $7 + \underline{\quad} = 10$ — best way: ten-partners.

Step 1. The whole is 10 and one part is 7, so the missing part is what is left of the ten-frame after 7 counters.

Step 2. Count the empty spaces: “8, 9, 10” — three of them. The missing part is $\boxed{3}$.

7. A number added to itself gives 8 — best way: doubles.

Step 1. “Added to itself” means both parts are the same, so ask which double makes 8.

Step 2. Run the doubles: $3 + 3 = 6$, $4 + 4 = 8$. Kim added $\boxed{4}$.

8. $\underline{\quad} + 2 = 10$ — best way: ten-partners.

Step 1. The whole is 10 and the known part is 2, so the missing part is the ten-partner of 2.

Step 2. Ten-partners come in pairs, and 2 pairs with 8 because $8 + 2 = 10$. The missing part is $\boxed{8}$.

9. Sam’s error on $2 + 6$.

Step 1. Sam picked the right strategy: hold the larger part, 6, and count on the smaller part, 2.

Step 2. His mistake is *where he started counting*. He said the 6 itself as his first count, so he only moved one step forward and landed on 7. The first thing you say must be the *next* number after the one you are holding.

Step 3. Counting correctly: “7, 8” — two counts, one for each of the 2. So $2 + 6 = \boxed{8}$.

10. Challenge: $2 + 3 + 5$.

Step 1. Three parts may be added in any order, so scan for a pair that makes a friendly number before adding left to right.

Step 2. 2 and 3 make 5, and 5 is the ten-partner of the remaining 5 — so group them as $(2 + 3) + 5$.

Step 3. $(2 + 3) + 5 = 5 + 5$, a double that is also a ten-partner pair, so the total is $\boxed{10}$.

Also correct: $2 + (3 + 5) = 2 + 8$, counted on, gives the same 10; credit any order with correct work.